IELTS & PTE ACADEMIC · MIXED SKILLS

# Mixed Practice: Reading, Listening and Writing

*Six short tasks in exam format, about 55 minutes*

LEVEL IELTS 6.0 to 7.0 / PTE 58 to 65 TIME 55 min FOCUS Scanning, spelling, cohesion

## 1 True, False or Not Given

IELTS Reading · Questions 1–5

*Read the passage, then decide whether statements 1–5 agree with the information in it.*

### Cooling the City

*Practice text written for this worksheet. All people named are fictional.*

**A** On a still summer afternoon, the centre of a large city can be several degrees warmer than the farmland around it. This effect, known as the urban heat island, is caused less by the sun itself than by what cities are made of. Asphalt, brick and concrete absorb heat during the day and release it slowly at night, so streets that feel bearable at noon can remain uncomfortable well after midnight.

**B** For many years the standard response was simply more air conditioning. Yet air-conditioning units pump warm air back into the street, and the electricity they use often comes from power stations that add to the problem. Urban climatologist Dr Ines Varga describes this as “cooling the inside by heating the outside” and argues that it can only ever be a short-term measure.

**C** Planners have therefore turned to passive solutions. The simplest is paint: roofs coated in pale, reflective material stay markedly cooler than dark ones. Street trees are more expensive to maintain, but they provide shade as well as cooling through evaporation from their leaves. According to landscape architect Tomás Reyes, a single mature tree can do more for a pavement than any new technology, “provided someone remembers to water it in its first three summers”.

**D** Green roofs, covered in soil and low-growing plants, have attracted the most attention. They insulate the buildings beneath them and absorb rainwater that would otherwise overload drains. However, they are heavy, and older buildings may need structural work before one can be installed. Building engineer Priya Nair points out that the cost of this work is rarely included in the optimistic figures quoted by suppliers.

**E** None of these measures is a complete answer on its own. Researchers increasingly speak of a “cooling network”: parks, tree-lined streets and reflective surfaces linked so that cool air can move through a neighbourhood. Whether cities have the patience to build such networks, which take decades rather than years to mature, remains an open question.

**TRUE** if the statement agrees with the information
**FALSE** if the statement contradicts the information
**NOT GIVEN** if there is no information on this

**1** Cities are warmer than the countryside mainly because they receive more sunlight. ☐

**2** Air conditioning can make the street outside a building warmer. ☐

**3** Reflective roof paint is now required by law in several cities. ☐

**4** Street trees cost more to look after than reflective roofs. ☐

**5** Residents generally prefer green roofs to street trees. ☐

## 2 Matching features

IELTS Reading · Questions 6–8

*Look at the people in the box and the statements 6–8. Match each statement with the correct person, A, B or C.*

PEOPLE

**A** Dr Ines Varga, urban climatologist
**B** Tomás Reyes, landscape architect
**C** Priya Nair, building engineer

**6** A low-cost measure may fail without basic care in its early years. ☐

**7** Suppliers tend to understate the full cost of a measure. ☐

**8** One common solution moves a problem rather than solving it. ☐

## 3 Note completion

IELTS Listening · Questions 9–14

*Your teacher will read a short talk once. Complete the notes. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.*

**Riverside Community Garden: volunteer induction**

- Meet at the **9** _____ next to the car park
- Saturdays, 9.30 to **10** _____
- Bring gloves and a **11** _____
- New volunteers: weeding and **12** _____
- Under **13** _____: come with an adult
- Coordinator: Josie **14** _____

## 4 Fill in the blanks

PTE Reading · Questions 15–19

*Choose the word from the box that best completes each gap. There are three words you do not need.*

**WORD BANK**

implications reinforce abundant random contradicts consolidate evidence reduces

Sleep researchers have long known that memory is not simply recorded during the day and stored at night. Instead, the sleeping brain appears to **15** _____ recent experiences, strengthening some connections and allowing others to fade. This process is not **16** _____: information linked to a reward, or that the learner expected to need later, is more likely to be retained. The **17** _____ for students are considerable. Revising late into the night may feel productive, but if it **18** _____ the total amount of sleep, it can undermine the very learning it was meant to **19** _____.

## 5 Re-order paragraphs

PTE Reading · Question 20

*The sentences below are in a random order. Write the letters in the correct order.*

**A** By marking each death on a street map, he showed that cases clustered around a single public water pump.

**B** At the time, most doctors believed the disease was spread through foul air.

**C** His map is now regarded as one of the founding documents of modern epidemiology.

**D** In 1854, a cholera outbreak killed hundreds of people within a few streets of central London.

**E** The physician John Snow, however, suspected that contaminated water was to blame.

**20** Correct order ☐ → ☐ → ☐ → ☐ → ☐

## 6 Write from dictation

PTE Listening · Questions 21–23

*Your teacher will read each sentence once. Write the sentence exactly as you hear it.*

**21** _____

**22** _____

**23** _____

## 7 Plan before you write

IELTS Writing Task 2

*Spend about eight minutes planning an answer to the question below. Use one line per move.*

*Some people think that young people should have to do unpaid community work in their free time. To what extent do you agree or disagree?*

**Position**

**Body paragraph 1: Point, Explain, Example**

**Body paragraph 2: Point, Explain, Example**

**Conclusion: link back to the question**